Kousha Ghodsizad

Systems & Infrastructure Architect

CONTACT

Amsterdam, Netherlands

+31 6 47 15 49 99

kousha@iraven.io

kousha.dev

linkedin.com/in/kousha-ghodsizad

github.com/koushamad

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend
Go, PHP, Python, Shell, APIs, services, workers, CLIs, service boundaries, integration layers

Infrastructure & Platform
Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Argo Events, Terraform, AWS, private cloud, OpenStack, Cilium, Vault/Consul, Harbor, Nexus

CI/CD & Automation
GitLab CI, Jenkins, deployment automation, merge-request automation, artifact workflows, release guardrails, operational tooling

Data & Messaging
MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, RabbitMQ, Kafka, NATS, Cassandra, ClickHouse, Elasticsearch, MongoDB

Observability & Reliability
Prometheus, Grafana, metrics, logging, readiness checks, operational dashboards, rollout safety, production feedback loops

Architecture
System design, reliability engineering, automation strategy, modular architecture, domain boundaries, technical review, engineering standards

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Software Engineering
Islamic Azad University · 2011 — 2015

ASc Computer Programming
Islamic Azad University · 2008 — 2011

References available on request.

SUMMARY

Systems & Infrastructure Architect / Platform Engineer with a backend engineering background and production experience across Kubernetes-based infrastructure, CI/CD, automation, observability, reliability, and distributed systems. I focus on building and improving platforms that make delivery safer, operations clearer, and backend systems easier to maintain.

My engineering style is calm, structured, and operationally mature: clarity over ambiguity, automation over repeated manual work, maintainability over short-term fixes, and reviewable architecture over accidental complexity. I contribute best through platform ownership, backend architecture, deployment reliability, technical review, and sustainable engineering practices.

CORE EXPERTISE

Platform Engineering: Internal platforms, production infrastructure, deployment reliability. Kubernetes-based production systems, Helm-based packaging, ArgoCD/GitOps delivery, private cloud environments, and platform workflows that support engineering teams. Strong focus on reliability, operational clarity, safe rollout patterns, and reducing friction in developer delivery paths.

Backend Systems: Go services, APIs, distributed systems, messaging. Backend services, APIs, workers, CLIs, service boundaries, integration layers, and data flows with particular strength in Go-based systems. Practical experience with messaging and data systems such as Redis, RabbitMQ, Kafka, NATS, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Cassandra, ClickHouse, Elasticsearch, and MongoDB.

CI/CD & Automation: Pipelines, operational tooling, infrastructure workflows. GitLab CI, Jenkins, deployment automation, merge-request automation, release guardrails, artifact workflows, and internal developer tooling. Automation mindset: make repeated operational work safer, easier to review, and easier for teams to understand.

Reliability & Observability: Metrics, monitoring, rollout safety, production debugging. Observability and reliability work using metrics, logs, readiness checks, dashboards, production feedback loops, and deployment hardening. Comfortable investigating system behaviour across application, infrastructure, pipeline, and database layers.

Architecture & Technical Leadership: System design, review, standards, operational improvements. Architecture review, service-boundary design, platform decision-making, engineering standards, mentoring, and technical ownership. Career progression from backend engineer to team lead and infrastructure/platform engineer, with increasing responsibility for system design and operational complexity.

EXPERIENCE

Adyen
Jul 2023 — Present

Infrastructure Engineer — CI/CD & Platform · Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Designed and improved production CI/CD and platform tooling around Kubernetes-based delivery workflows, with attention to deployment reliability and operational clarity.
- Worked with Helm, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, GitLab/Jenkins integrations, artifact systems, and internal automation to make delivery paths safer and easier to operate.
- Built and maintained Go-based developer/platform tooling, including CLI and service integrations for controlled plugin execution and workflow automation.
- Improved deployment hardening, observability, and operational feedback loops so teams could understand merge requests, releases, logs, metrics, and post-deployment behaviour more clearly.
- Collaborated across teams on review, architecture, reliability concerns, and practical automation for production infrastructure.

Studocu
Jul 2022 — Jul 2023

Senior Software Engineer · Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Improved backend and platform-facing areas around website performance, crawler accessibility, and production reliability.
- Worked with operations and platform teams to add monitoring across local, staging, and production environments.
- Built CI/CD checks for SEO and performance testing to make release quality more repeatable and easier to validate.
- Investigated bottlenecks across application and database layers and translated findings into practical engineering improvements.

Amazon Web Services (AWS) · S3 · SNS · SQS · RDS · DevOps · PHP · Laravel · Go · Big Data · Test Driven Development (TDD) · MySQL · ElasticSearch · Redis

KolayIK
May 2021 — May 2022

Senior Software Engineer / Backend Team Lead · Istanbul, Turkey

- Led backend and platform-oriented work across HR systems, expense management, data import/export, and queue-based services.
- Applied modular architecture, domain boundaries, TDD, messaging, AWS services, and Kubernetes where appropriate to improve maintainability and operational behaviour.
- Built automation for failure reporting and operational feedback, including queue handling and Slack-integrated reporting.
- Supported delivery through technical review, design direction, mentoring, and pragmatic engineering standards.

Wingie Enuygun Group
May 2020 — Apr 2021

Senior Software Engineer / Team Lead · Istanbul, Turkey

- Led hotel-provider integration work and backend services for provider aggregation, search, caching, and data pipelines.
- Designed Go/gRPC services to manage concurrent provider requests and standardise hotel data from external systems.
- Improved reliability through testing practices, Elasticsearch tuning, cache-rate management, and database cluster migration work.
- Guided the team through technical review, testing workshops, and delivery decisions that balanced reliability with business needs.

Hexagonal Architecture · Microservices · Amazon Web Services (AWS) · DevOps · PHP · Go · Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) · Web Applications · Design Patterns · Big Data · Test Driven Development · MySQL · MongoDB · Symfony

Insider
Jun 2019 — Jun 2020

Senior Software Engineer · Istanbul, Turkey

- Refactored newsletter and email-delivery systems from legacy structures toward clearer service boundaries.
- Worked on Go services, messaging, security remediation, and data migration across high-volume marketing data systems.
- Improved maintainability through architecture review, repository-service patterns, and clearer data-flow design.
- Built supporting services for A/B testing, spam detection, and queue-based processing.

RabbitMQ · Amazon Web Services (AWS) · DevOps · PHP · Go (Programming Language) · Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) · Design Patterns · Test Driven Development · MySQL · MongoDB · Leadership · Teamwork · Management · Redis

Bamilo
Aug 2015 — Apr 2019

Senior Software Engineer / Head of Development · Tehran, Iran

- Built and led engineering work across seller tooling, warehouse operations, delivery tracking, inventory services, and internal platforms.
- Owned backend architecture, service design, team growth, and technical review for marketplace operations systems.
- Designed data migration pipelines and service improvements for inventory and seller-centre workflows.
- Helped convert operational problems into maintainable systems for logistics, warehouse, seller, and marketplace teams.

RabbitMQ · Kubernetes · GraphQL · Amazon Web Services (AWS) · DevOps · PHP · Laravel · Go (Programming Language) · Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) · Design Patterns · MySQL · MongoDB · Leadership · Management · Redis · Cassandra · Apache Kafka

Sepehr Mahan Tech
Aug 2012 — Jul 2015

Software Engineer / Senior Software Engineer · Tehran, Iran

- Developed suggestion, task-management, meeting-management, form-builder, workflow, social-network, and mobile API systems.
- Focused on backend services, process automation, maintainable application foundations, and practical delivery for private and public-sector clients.
- Built the early backend and product-engineering foundation that later grew into larger platform, architecture, and leadership responsibilities.

Linux · PHP · JavaScript · Python (Programming Language) · Node.js · SQL · MySQL · Redis · MongoDB · RabbitMQ · Design Patterns · Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) · Teamwork

SELECTED PROJECTS

ChanceGoal
Product platform and backend architecture

Go API, admin/web clients, iOS, onboarding, notifications, operational tooling

- Worked across backend APIs, admin/web clients, mobile flows, local runtime automation, and service-level tests.
- Implemented backend foundations around authentication, onboarding state, notifications, persistence, and operational tooling.
- Used the project to refine maintainable platform patterns across product architecture, API design, deployment, and developer workflows.

Zenory.fit

Multi-platform wellness ecosystem

Next.js 15, TypeScript, Supabase, iOS (Swift), Garmin ConnectIQ, browser extension

- Built a multi-platform product spanning a Next.js marketing and web app, iOS app, Garmin ConnectIQ watch app, and a Firefox browser extension backed by Supabase.
- Designed a creator and instructor platform (Zenory Senseis) alongside feature-specific flows for meditation, sleep, music, routines, and goals.
- Established shared content, deployment, and operational foundations across web, native, and wearable targets with consistent delivery patterns.

Socc360.com

Global football intelligence platform

Next.js 15, React 19, TypeScript, Tailwind v4, iOS (Swift), real-time data integration

- Built a web and iOS product consuming a live football data API across 15 routes covering scores, fixtures, leagues, teams, players, match timelines, and editorial news.
- Designed a shared "Cobalt & Amber" design system used consistently across the web app and iOS app, including motion, typography, and colour tokens.
- Focused on real-time overlays, editorial-quality presentation, and a strict information-only product boundary with no betting or market features.

Pepper.com Platform Work

Marketplace microservices work · Remote / Berlin

Backend services, GraphQL flows, image service work, near-cache behaviour

- Collaborated with Supernova and microservice teams to develop features, maintain services, and improve backend behaviour.
- Redesigned and developed deal submission, product listing, and product detail flows using GraphQL.
- Worked on image-service capabilities, near-cache behaviour, load-balancing improvements, and microservice security review.

GraphQL · Amazon Web Services (AWS) · SQS · SNS · RDS · S3 · ELB · Microservice · PHP · Laravel · Go · Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) · Design Patterns · Test Driven Development (TDD) · ElasticSearch · Redis

RECOMMENDATIONS

Ryan Klann — VP of Engineering, Pepper.com

“Kousha is a developer who has very strong technical skills and has shown to be able to take responsibility for a project and be relied upon. If there is something technical that he doesn't understand he will jump right in and learn what he needs in order to solve the problem. It's been a pleasure working with you.”

Nikola Barac — Head of Software Engineering, Pepper.com

“Kousha worked on pepper.com features as a senior PHP developer and took ownership of one of our most important microservices written in Go. He demonstrated passion for tackling challenging problems, staying o hours until they got solved and following up the next days. While working on his daily tasks he was often paying attention to security issues that many developers often neglect. Kousha was a valuable team member and I would be very happy to work with him again!”

Hooman Moghani — Product Manager, Insider

“Kousha is amazing at his job! He is one of the most brilliant engineers that I've worked with, one of the best in his field, and is always willing to share best practices. He was always very committed and focused on delivering on time. He was a top performer and inspired us to give our best. Anyone would be lucky to have Kousha as a colleague.”

Gizem Sevinç — CTO and Co-founder, Kolay

“Kousha is a talented software developer that I thoroughly enjoy working with. Thanks to its extensive knowledge in backend technologies, it provides effective and fast solutions to many problems. Highly recommended if you are working with PHP, Phyton, or Go.”

Mehrab Sadooghianzadeh — CTO, Dreamdays

“Kousha is a talented expert in many development areas.”

Mana Azizi — Group Product Director, Bamilo (Rocket Internet SE)
“I believe Kousha as a talented full-stack software developer with a creative mind which is coming not only from his intelligence but also from his broad experience. He posses strong analytical mind which is absolutely invaluable for a developer. His calm attitude in addition to his knowledge and experience makes him a precious asset for any company targeting large-scale platforms development.”

Raha Molaie — HR Administrator, Bamilo (Rocket Internet SE)
“It was a short time after Bamilo (our former company) that we both worked together closely but with no doubt, Kousha is one of the maturest people I've ever worked with and I can call his personality "Self-HR", I've never heard that word before but I like to use it due to defining Kousha's behavior and leadership ability and also being easy going and helpfulness. He always gave me hand on colleagues' issues in the best way. He definitely is a valuable asset to any organization.”